Russian Federation's vital financial strengths are significant oil and gas-producing countries and vast foreign exchange reserves. By March 31, 2016, Russia has reached USD 328.871 million foreign exchange reserves (International Reserves of the Russian Federation 2017).[21] Likewise, by May 2021, Russia's foreign exchange reserves have gone up to US $600.9 billion. It is the highest level ever that is the US $2 billion more than the previous all-time high just before the global financial crisis (Aris 2021). More importantly, Russia has a very low government debt, at 17.7 percent only (Trading Economics 2015).[22] However, Russia's government debt rose to 40 percent by 2020. The Audit Chamber, a Russia's government spending watchdog, says that Russia's debt stood at 19 trillion rubles, equal to the US $257 billion at the end of 2020 and equivalent to 17.8 percent of Russia's GDP. But one interesting fact is that it is still one of the lowest debt rates in the world (The Moscow Times, February 24, 2021). Russia is a market-driven economy, which is primarily dependent on energy exports. However, Russia has a weak environment filled with public and quasi-public companies (Kondapalli and Pandith 2016: xli).

The Russian economy displays robust macroeconomic data, making it the 7th largest economy globally with its 143 million population. It has approximately 2 trillion 223 billion dollars of gross domestic product in purchasing power parity. Unlike other Western countries, Russia has been relatively resilient in the face of global volatility and other BRICS countries (Akulov 2012). However, it is slipped to the eleventh position by 2020. According to the IMF's report, the country's economy grew by 4 percent in 2010, 4.3 percent in 2011 and performed well in 2012. Even despite the West's sanctions on Russia, it performed well with the help of China. In 2013, it was 1.3 percent; in 2014, it was 0.6 (IMF Reports of 2013 and 2014)[23] percent, notwithstanding the geopolitical setbacks for Russia in International Relations. Likewise, the World Bank report says that Russia's GDP growth is expected to rise at 3.2 percent in 2021, followed by 3.2 percent and 2.3 percent in 2022 and 2023, respectively. The World Bank reports also said global economic recovery, higher oil prices, and soft domestic monetary conditions in 2021 are projected to help a rally led by household consumption and public investment in Russia.

Though it expected a slow growth rate in the coming years, it could never get as bad as the West. The damages recovered as trade between Russia and China continued to increase rapidly. And BRICS is mulling at